

Speaker 1 [00:00:04] All right. Now recording. All right. I want to thank you again for participating in the interview. As mentioned over text, we just want to know more about your views on romantic relationships. And we believe your experience and perspective would bring much to the project. Before we start, is it okay if we record for no taking and tranche transcription purposes? Yes. Awesome. Okay, let's start. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:32] I am [31-40] years old.

Speaker 1 [00:00:35] Okay. And how long have you been together with your partner? Oh.

Speaker 2 [00:00:41] [11-15] years. Yeah. [11-15]. Yeah. [11-15] years.

Speaker 1 [00:00:47] We've.

Speaker 2 [00:00:48] Been together. [6-10] of those years. I believe that we met when I was [16-20]. I'm [31-40] now. So, yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:00:57] I was married for [6-10] years and dating for [1-5] year about now.

Speaker 2 [00:01:02] So I am not legally married. I'm not like, we're probably not going to have an illegal marriage any time soon just because I don't want children. So there's no rush or like, legal implications. But we are partners in the sense that it's more of like a domestic partnership.

Speaker 1 [00:01:21] Okay. Just see. I know. Legal contract behind it. Correct. Do you think in the future you will get married and have children?

Speaker 2 [00:01:31] I'm not having children. I've thought about freezing my eggs but what If I change my mind. And that's something we recently started talking about. But no children as far as marriage, you know, our views are pretty much that we treat each other as husband and wife. However, as far as getting the legal documentation on it, there's no rush for that just because we aren't going to have children, but we will likely get legally married just because of how we operate under taxes as well as the other benefits that a legal marriage has in the United States.

Speaker 1 [00:02:13] Right. I heard there's a lot more benefits of being married when you get older or just like all those like retirement taxes.

Speaker 2 [00:02:23] Exactly. In addition to that, we own investments together. And so we have an [company] for that right now. Again, a lot easier when there is a legal contract for the marriage there. So.

Speaker 1 [00:02:36] Right. And who lives in your household.

Speaker 2 [00:02:41] So I just him and myself. And then we have two dogs.

Speaker 1 [00:02:47] Okay. What kind of dogs?

Speaker 2 [00:02:50] One's a [Dog Breed]. And then one is, I think, a [Dog Breed]? We're not sure we got their DNA done, so we'll see shortly.

Speaker 1 [00:02:59] Oh, okay. I have a multiple also.

Speaker 2 [00:03:01] Oh, goodness. What's your dog's name?

Speaker 1 [00:03:04] [Dog Name A].

Speaker 2 [00:03:05] Ours is [Dog Name B].

Speaker 1 [00:03:06] [Dog Name A] is [Dog Breed]. Do you look like teddy bears? I always say my dog looks like a teddy bear.

Speaker 2 [00:03:12] Yes, that is. I love [Dog Breed]. I will never go back. I want another one. So.

Speaker 1 [00:03:18] Right. It was like my dream dog when I was a kid. And I finally would, like, convince my whole family to get it. And I love that. Oh, my goodness. Right. So you said you had some investments, but what's your main source of income?

Speaker 2 [00:03:33] Yeah. So I am employed. I do, I have a full time job, but I also own and operate a business as well. I am the sole employee of that.

Speaker 1 [00:03:46] So I have just incomes.

Speaker 2 [00:03:50] But those are like my primary sources.

Speaker 1 [00:03:54] What kind of business?

Speaker 2 [00:03:56] I actually own a [business A], so I have a [location] in which I operate [Service]. In addition to that, I'm expanding, so I'm going to be purchasing a building. So then like leasing my building to other [Business A] and creating another.

Speaker 1 [00:04:18] [Business A] from that.

Speaker 2 [00:04:19] So I am also a [Job Title] at a [Company]. And so I've been working on with this current company that I'm employed at for around [1-5] years scaling it. So it's been quite busy. So that's why I know children.

Speaker 1 [00:04:38] You're definitely way too busy to take care of anything else right now. And so how would you like for us to address your partner or boyfriend? Partner?

Speaker 2 [00:04:51] Partners.

Speaker 1 [00:04:51] Fine. Okay. And can you tell me a little bit about your love story?

Speaker 2 [00:04:58] Yeah. So we kind of live in a small, big town, right? I went to [College A], he went to [College B] and we had mutual friends and which kind of connected us not on purpose or anything, but we met through our mutual friends. And ever since the first time meeting, we just pretty much always knew, like this person was probably the one like the one person that we were going to spend our lives with. And we were in college. So we were still pretty young and just kind of like navigating life. So we did start officially dating, like I would say two years after we really, like, met and we're very interested in each other. And then I would say after college we got more serious as far as just talking about our relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:05:52] And.

Speaker 2 [00:05:52] Kind of like making sure our ideologies were the same, because I'm a very, I would say, nontraditional woman in the fact that I'm not going to play into gender roles, I'm not going to be cleaning, I'm not going to be taking care of household chores. In that sense. It's just not something that I have envisioned in my life. And so I wanted to make sure that I had a partner who was aware of that and knew that I'm not going to be popping out kids. I'm going to be primarily focused on life building and success and the things that I want and the life that I want is very much so curated to not being in a specific gender role in a relationship. And so he was very on board with that from a very early age. And so that kind of again, we moved in together and then.

Speaker 1 [00:06:44] That.

Speaker 2 [00:06:44] Took a while too, because again, I like to have my own space. And so I think like we've been together so long, but we've also really respected each other's lives and like interests and boundaries. And so I would say it was kind of like a whirlwind romance at first where, you know, all these like, you know, fun things were happening and then it kind of progressively got more and more serious.

Speaker 1 [00:07:09] Okay. Would you say that he takes on any gender roles or.

Speaker 2 [00:07:16] He is so wonderful. He cooks way more than me. He cleans way more than me. He also has a full time job. He is probably out of all of the people that I do know that are married and who talk to me about like, you know, their relationships. He does a lot and is a really good dog dad, too.

Speaker 1 [00:07:38] Oh yeah, that's always nice to have. It's hard nowadays. People have expectations for, you know, women are just in general having those gender roles.

Speaker 2 [00:07:49] It's hard to try to keep it like you know what I mean? Like if I'm having a busier week, he'll pick up in certain areas. If I'm having a slower week, you know, I pick up as well. But then we do things to make our lives easier. Like we, you know, we'll occasionally get a cleaner to come in here. I'm trying to get them to come in more now that our lives are a little bit busier, like meal prepping and stuff. We get delivery for all of that. So we've done things that are like, we'll save us time and so we can spend our time doing the things that we like a little bit more as far as getting to hang out and stuff.

Speaker 1 [00:08:27] Right. That sounds like an awesome, awesome relationship and like how you guys balance each other. But also, you know, you don't have to feel like you need to do any of those things like, you know, cooking or cleaning. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:08:44] And I do enjoy cooking sometimes, so I will when I'm feeling, you know, as though I have time. But it's not like a thing that it's just expected from one person or the other.

Speaker 1 [00:08:55] Yeah, that's awesome. And how would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to that of your friends' relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:09:06] I think my relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:09:08] Is.

Speaker 2 [00:09:09] Really, really.

Speaker 1 [00:09:11] Just.

Speaker 2 [00:09:12] I'm not trying to sound like a pygmy, but a lot of my friends complain about the most basic things with their relationships that would just be solved with communication. And so I feel like because [Partner] is so level headed and really balances me out, I can communicate with him in a way that's very direct and clear, and he is very understanding and will always take time to listen. Whereas other relationships, I think their partners are a little bit more reactive or hotheaded. And so sometimes it's hard for them to communicate with their partners because they're, you know, kind of stepping on eggshells. And I feel like sometimes.

Speaker 1 [00:09:55] I think.

Speaker 2 [00:09:57] But, you know, you only hear certain pieces like when you're friends. One event about things is like the good things. So I would say it's hard to not have a biased opinion on certain pieces of the relationship. But I do know my friends are always very complimentary of my relationship and are very open to just giving kudos to the relationship that we've formed as well as the opinions of our families as well, has always been very, very positive on that end. And I can tell you that that's not always been the case with people that I've dated.

Speaker 1 [00:10:32] So. Can you give me an example of when your friends would complain about their relationship? Like, what would that look like?

Speaker 2 [00:10:44] Yeah. So I guess a lot of the things that revolve around like the cooking, the cleaning, the dog stuff, or the things that I think are more kind of like the hidden tasks that women just start to pick up over time. Scheduling that, appointments, scheduling, doctor's appointments, things like that. I believe that there is a name like kin, something like kin responsibilities. It's kind of like the behind the scenes stuff in which they have to take care of over time and great. And none of my friends have kids now. So it's just they're just either, you know, in these long term relationships, married. And so it just sounds a lot as though, you know, there's like a lot of pressure for them to do certain things. And it's kind of like unspoken. Whereas, you know, I think the modern day woman, like we are working just as.

Speaker 1 [00:11:42] Much.

Speaker 2 [00:11:42] Or maybe even more.

Speaker 1 [00:11:44] Than.

Speaker 2 [00:11:45] The men in our households. And for us to take on more responsibility without it being communicated is just honestly, I think, something that can cause strains over time in a relationship if it's not addressed early on. But I.

Speaker 1 [00:12:01] Do.

Speaker 2 [00:12:02] Feel as though if you're complaining without coming up with some sort of solution, you're not really brought in to fixing the problem. And so that's my advice, is always talk about it, do something about it. Don't just complain about the same thing over and over and over and expect the same outcome because that's ridiculous.

Speaker 1 [00:12:19] Do you think it's because you did establish that you are going to do those certain things that are expected of women? Is that why you think that it's different for you guys or do you think it's more that you guys are effective at communicating?

Speaker 2 [00:12:35] I think it's just because I'm very direct and I don't beat around the bush and I really don't care to talk about something more than a few times. If I have to tell you something more than once, then.

Speaker 1 [00:12:48] That's.

Speaker 2 [00:12:49] Kind of to me, like open your ears and listen. Because if I'm taking the time to communicate something that's important, then there needs to be a level of respect on receiving that, you know? And so I think that's established as well within our relationship. If one of us has something to communicate, we're going to sit down and make sure we fully understand. And we've talked about that before, or at least I have. But I also think that, you know, it maybe is.

Speaker 1 [00:13:19] Like. Well.

Speaker 2 [00:13:23] I wouldn't say maturity level, but I think that there is something to be said about like people who mature at different rates. And I think that some of these people may be just. Haven't grown up as quickly as [Partner] and myself, like we both grew up pretty quickly, you know, as far as just like.

Speaker 1 [00:13:44] How.

Speaker 2 [00:13:45] We want to live our lives and, you know, how we make decisions. I do think there is a level of maturity there that comes over time.

Speaker 1 [00:13:55] Yeah, it definitely does seem like you guys have more maturity. Compare that to your friends. So can I ask how many romantic partners you've had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:14:08] Yeah. Define romantic. Are we talking like relationships? Are we talking like, anything?

Speaker 1 [00:14:14] I think it'd be more how you would define what you think a romantic relationship is.

Speaker 2 [00:14:20] Yeah. So. Okay, well, I've had a few boyfriends, and I will define that as, like, romantic relationships. And they were when I was, you know, younger. So, like, my kind of, like, high school to, like, early college years.

Speaker 1 [00:14:38] Okay, so, like, to.

Speaker 2 [00:14:40] Yeah, I'm like, how many? Yeah, two.

Speaker 1 [00:14:44] Okay. And how would you compare the quality of your relationship now compared to the previous relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:14:52] Oh, 100% different. I was with fuck boys before and I think you do really have to. Like experience both sides of relationships to really have established boundaries. I also think that's what kind of separates me from some of my friends, is they haven't had a bad relationship in the past where I'm like, That's a red sign. Like, that is a red flag. You need to address that early on. But I think because again, that's one of the things is, you know, you go through hard things and it's a life experience and you need to learn from it. I was able to learn from those relationships. Tortuous relationships. I would not even wish them upon my worst enemy, but I would do it again because I learned a lot.

Speaker 1 [00:15:43] Right. And that's what I always try to tell my brother, that you need to just take it as a learning experience and not like so much as a heartbreak.

Speaker 2 [00:15:51] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:15:52] That's a sign. All exes are more like a learning experience of what not to do and what to do.

Speaker 2 [00:15:59] Exactly. 100%.

Speaker 1 [00:16:03] And for you, what makes a relationship high quality and low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:16:08] I think high quality is just like laughing together and talking and spending time and making memories and doing things like it doesn't even have to be like an exciting thing, but like, just like spending time any time that we got to connect and kind of unwind is like quality. I think just like, you know, some of my best memories that I would like consider quality.

Speaker 1 [00:16:36] Like.

Speaker 2 [00:16:36] Things in our relationship have been some of the smallest things. And then the other side of the question was like, what would I consider low quality?

Speaker 1 [00:16:46] Yeah, what would make such a low quality relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:16:51] I think egos make a low quality relationship. I think you really have to, if you want to have a successful relationship, sometimes be able to put your ego aside and understand that, you know, we're all living a human experience and like how to communicate effectively is not going to be based off of your own individual preference when dealing with another person, you have to take into consideration how they want. So I think ego, just ego, is a very low quality thing in a relationship. If you cannot put your ego aside, I don't think you'll probably have very successful relationships.

Speaker 1 [00:17:34] Can you give me an example of what you'd say like an egotistic boyfriend would be?

Speaker 2 [00:17:40] Maybe someone who doesn't take accountability for their actions or wants to be right instead of solving the issue? Yeah, I think that's kind of like in some what I would think. It's just some of like the standouts for having someone like egotistical around is, you know, you can never be right in front of that person or you're never going to get like

an apology, you know, Or it's not even about getting an apology. It's just about like. You probably don't want to be spending time fighting with people who.

Speaker 1 [00:18:11] Can.

Speaker 2 [00:18:13] Not take accountability for their actions because you're in it. It's a dead end road.

Speaker 1 [00:18:17] Right? It's pretty much impossible at that point. And if they agree with you just to stop the fight, it's not because they actually think that way. So when you say that your relationship was one, would you say your relationship was the most like quality to spending quality time with each other? And when would you say it's at least.

Speaker 2 [00:18:45] I think day to day. Is this more like a broad question, like in general from the period of our relationship, or is this like current, like now when is the best quality and like least quality.

Speaker 1 [00:18:59] You have throughout your whole entire relationship? When have you experienced like low quality or spending like less quality time together? And then a time where you a time throughout, sometimes throughout your relationship when you spend high, high quality time together?

Speaker 2 [00:19:16] Oh, that's tricky. Because I don't think I would consider one like. I can't think of a time that has felt like super like low quality. I'm trying to.

Speaker 1 [00:19:28] Think. I think.

Speaker 2 [00:19:34] Maybe I'll go to the first part and I'll circle back to the second part of the question. I think it's just like the quality. I think it's been through our relationship, but just like different things. So, you know, when we were younger, it was like a lot of just like, you know, events and things like that that we were really excited to do together. And then as we progressed and started getting our careers in line, like, you know, purchasing our first homes, like he purchased a home. I purchased a home. I started my business. He got an amazing job promotion. And then, like, getting our dogs has been such a highlight and all of that and being able to travel together and, like, afford certain things that we just couldn't when we were younger. Low quality. I feel like. And I'll have to kind of get a little bit more granular with this because I can't think of like any time period. But I do think like throughout the week when we do get focused on a little bit more on work, it's really hard to feel like connected in that, like quality time together. But yeah, I can't pinpoint like a time where I would feel like it's low quality.

Speaker 1 [00:20:45] Okay. Do you do anything to like, help you guys spend more quality time throughout the week when you are busy? We just have to balance it.

Speaker 2 [00:20:57] You know, if we're both really busy during the week because with my [Business A], like, I can be coming home at 10 p.m. at night and that's on top of working a full day at another company. And so we just make sure that like at least one day during the weekend or like Mondays when I'm not doing my beauty business, like we'll do something on the days that I know I don't have anything planned. He doesn't have anything planned. We'll do like a dinner together or something like that.

Speaker 1 [00:21:26] Okay. And for you, what are the most important things in a relationship? And why do you say so? Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:21:34] So I think for me. I think this will probably be pretty standard from anyone that you've talked to. But like communication is a big thing because you need to have a level of understanding each other and you have to be able to communicate your needs. The second is just being able to. I'm trying to think like a laugh and like I'm. What would that be called, though? I'm like, trying to pinpoint it down to one.

Speaker 1 [00:22:04] Like.

Speaker 2 [00:22:04] Theme here. I think quality time. And then of course, like friendship I think is a really important part. Like you have to. It's not just like, you know, a romantic relationship, but like, this is like a really strong bond, like a friendship, almost. Trying to think of that. But there's other things, too. But I think I'll just go with those three for now.

Speaker 1 [00:22:31] Okay? Like when you say friendship, do you mean like, spending? Like doing the same? Like game to like to do the same things together, I guess.

Speaker 2 [00:22:39] Like, respect. Like, maybe that's a better, like, word for it.

Speaker 1 [00:22:44] Respect. Okay. And for you, what is love?

Speaker 2 [00:22:51] Yeah, I think love is just honestly like experiencing the high focal points of life and living in the moment and really kind of understanding like. Like all, like. Like in order to, like, feel love or to know what love is like, you kind of have to experience, like, the opposite sides of that as well.

Speaker 1 [00:23:14] So it.

Speaker 2 [00:23:16] Like in a weird just posed way can be also like tragedy and like losing someone or.

Speaker 1 [00:23:22] You.

Speaker 2 [00:23:22] Know what I mean? So I think love is like a whole range of emotions that manifest through life events sometimes.

Speaker 1 [00:23:31] And how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:23:35] I think it's very, very important. I think if you. Have love for somebody. It kind of like. Like, I don't even know how to describe it. I don't think I've ever talked about something like this.

Speaker 1 [00:23:51] And I think.

Speaker 2 [00:23:51] It's like, Yeah, I think it's very important, right?

Speaker 1 [00:23:54] It's like I.

Speaker 2 [00:23:56] Could never be with somebody that I didn't love, if that makes sense. Like, I don't know. And it's a different kind of love than your family because you're

choosing to love this person, right? Like your family. Like you just kind of grow up. You know? You love them, but. Like with a romantic like partner or a relationship, Like, you kind of have to make a choice, like to to love that person even through, like, anything hard or, you know, things that are unforeseeable.

Speaker 1 [00:24:26] Yeah. And how do you know your partner loves you? I feel like.

Speaker 2 [00:24:34] It's very easy to tell with [Partner]. He is like such a lovely person and all of like the. Like, typical, like textbook ways. But then even like, further than that, he's just constantly thinking about me. Like, every kind of thought that he has, I can tell like, he always, like, just wants me to be happy and like, the best for me. And I think that comes from a really good place. And then of course, there's like all of the other stuff. He's super affectionate and he's always complimentary of me and like, wants to spend time with me and just, you know, is constantly kind of gassing me up and really proud of me. And just I think that's kind of like, yeah, I touched all the points there.

Speaker 1 [00:25:23] Okay. And what would you say are some challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:25:29] I think time. I think we wish we had more time together. He travels for work. I'm busy with work. Just in general. And I think one of the things as well is that I am an introvert and he is an extrovert, so I want him to go do things with his friends to give him an outlet of, Hey, like you get to go socialize, have fun. But he always wants me there, whereas that's very draining for me. I don't need to be in every single social situation. I'm also very protective over who I share my energy with, even. You know what I mean? Like, I take a lot of time for myself. And so I think that's one of the like a big pain points is I want him to be happy and to have his social time, but he wants me there. I don't want to be there for everything. And so sometimes I can tell it's a little disappointing for him if I don't want to go somewhere or do something social. And I'll always try my best to do something a little bit more social at least. Like for every like, no, I dish out like I always try to just shout out yes to counteract it. So it's like a compromise, you know? But I just think that's kind of a pain point is he is Mr. Social. It's like the epitome of like the classic, like kind of black cat, like golden retriever relationship where he knows every single neighbor by name. I've not met one of our neighbors. I don't care what their names are, to be quite honest.

Speaker 2 [00:27:09] Can all get along and are respectful of each other's boundaries. But he has all of their numbers. He makes friends with everyone. And I'm just very like to myself.

Speaker 1 [00:27:19] So yeah, well, that's a good balance to have. You know, he you keep him reserved and he brings you at your shell sometimes. Exactly. So do you guys fight?

Speaker 2 [00:27:32] Yeah, we do. We fight. We fight over the stupidest things. It's actually comical.

Speaker 1 [00:27:40] How often would you say these fights are? Oh, goodness. They'll be like.

Speaker 2 [00:27:45] A little fight, maybe like once a week. And then we're laughing about something else. But. I think it's not even like a serious fight. Like, I can't remember the

time. Like we've had, like, a sit down, like. This was like you crossed a boundary or you did this or anything like that. But we'll definitely bicker.

Speaker 1 [00:28:07] We will bicker. Yeah. And what would you guys bicker about?

Speaker 2 [00:28:13] And he does not like my backseat driving. I don't like his driving. There's, I don't know. I'm just like, particular. So I'm like, kind of nit picky and I'm trying to work on it. But I will definitely like stuff with the dogs that stresses me. I'll be like, Now it needs to be like, Done this way. And he's like, Stay in your lane and then I'll have to like, pull it back together or like, argue over, you know, kind of like, Oh, I want to go out to eat. No, I don't like. Absolutely not. Pretty basic stuff. I would say it's pretty uneventful as far as like the arguing side of things. And then we'll definitely laugh afterwards. It's usually me. I'm definitely the more like moody, temperamental one.

Speaker 1 [00:29:04] Yeah. So like, um, like old, old couples fighting.

Speaker 2 [00:29:08] Exactly. But yeah, I can't recall, like, a real fight that we've had that hasn't been, like, about food or dogs or driving or something like.

Speaker 1 [00:29:19] Just stupid. And how do you resolve these little fights that you get out?

Speaker 2 [00:29:26] I usually need like 5 minutes.

Speaker 1 [00:29:28] To, like.

Speaker 2 [00:29:29] Be to myself if I'm in a mood and then I'll apologize because it's usually me, like the one who's.

Speaker 1 [00:29:36] Like.

Speaker 2 [00:29:37] A little bit more intense.

Speaker 1 [00:29:38] Antagonistic.

Speaker 2 [00:29:40] In particular. And then we'll laugh it off usually. But if I've done something like, you know, where I've lost my cool and I raised my voice, like, I'll definitely give him like a very sincere apology and tell him, like, you know, hey, I'm going to work on this.

Speaker 1 [00:29:57] Like, I won't.

Speaker 2 [00:29:58] Do this again.

Speaker 1 [00:29:58] Like.

Speaker 2 [00:30:00] And we'll kind of, like, come up with, like, a solution of like, okay, like, this is what set me off like this. This all the things that happened before. Let's make sure, like, if I'm getting to this point, like, if I, you know, give you a sign, like, hey, let's not talk about this right now. Like, let's not talk about it.

Speaker 1 [00:30:18] And what are other ways you maintain your relationship besides you apologized again. Just like over little fights. Besides the little fights, how would you contain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:30:31] Yeah, I think as far as just like, maintaining, trying to spend quality time together, trying to make sure that, you know, we're growing together. I think that's really important for maintaining a relationship as. I don't mind being stagnant. And this is almost to me like a fault sometimes is I'm always kind of like, focused on like what is coming next instead of sitting like and being present in the moment. And so I.

Speaker 1 [00:31:03] Think.

Speaker 2 [00:31:04] Slowing myself down and becoming very present and just like the day to day and being thankful for what I have now instead of what I want and like what my goals are, I think that's a way of maintaining a good relationship because it's really easy to get lost in the.

Speaker 1 [00:31:18] Like.

Speaker 2 [00:31:19] Because every time I've gotten a goal or gotten something that I wanted, I immediately forget it. I'm not even like, thankful. I'm just like, how can I get like the next step? So I think that's really healthy too, is like slowing down and like being present. And then it said spending quality time. So we've been like traveling together more. We went to Europe this summer, which was really fun. And then just making sure that I think like we have things like travel plans like booked in, like things set aside for ourselves to do.

Speaker 1 [00:31:56] Do you have any new travel plans coming up?

Speaker 2 [00:32:00] Yes, we're going back to [Region] towards end of the year and then.

Speaker 1 [00:32:06] We'll.

Speaker 2 [00:32:06] Probably go to [State] sometime in between there. And then we have a few weddings coming up next year that will involve traveling. And so but I think, yeah, that's our goal is to try to just still like some. Quality travel time together because usually it's with friends or like this or that. And I've made it very clear, like when we go on vacation, I don't mind if we have a few days with friends, but like, let's peel away and do like some stuff that's just one on one. And so he's been very open to that.

Speaker 1 [00:32:39] Is it easy for you guys to make travel plans with all the work you have?

Speaker 2 [00:32:44] Not for me. For him, yes. So for me, I kind of need to be like, just book it and tell me like, I cannot be involved with the booking of the tickets because I will literally, like, think myself to death over, like, trying to get things figured out first. So he is very good at just booking things and then telling me what I need to do to get ready. And so then I'm like, okay, not going to be taking clients from this time to this time, like getting everything kind of like prepared mentally. So I think that part is a little bit easier now. But before I was a little bit more resistant when I was trying to build.

Speaker 1 [00:33:22] You know.

Speaker 2 [00:33:23] Certain. Just like milestones for myself. But yeah, but and before when we.

Speaker 1 [00:33:29] Had, like.

Speaker 2 [00:33:30] I don't know, like [6-10] weddings when we one year and they were so much travel and we were in the bridal parties and so we had to do the bachelorettes and the bachelor parties. So that year it was like no time for us to travel together. And that was like we definitely felt like that was a sprint. And once the weddings cooled off, we wanted to be able to spend quality time just as two. So we finally were able to do that.

Speaker 1 [00:33:58] This year was like right after COVID whenever. Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:34:02] So many weddings. Oh my God.

Speaker 1 [00:34:05] I'm like. Yeah, I wasn't in that age range or my friends are getting married yet Now it's starting to happen, but it's going to.

Speaker 2 [00:34:16] Hit you too. And just I always tell people who are younger truly understand what it means to be a bridesmaid before you say yes, and you have full authority to say, no, I don't want to be a bridesmaid because you are going to be spending tens of thousands of dollars on your friends. Like that's the I've at least spent like [Amount] being in weddings.

Speaker 1 [00:34:40] So it was like pay for the bridal shower and stuff for the bachelorette party.

Speaker 2 [00:34:49] You pay for everything, basically. And then if you have to travel for the wedding, like.

Speaker 1 [00:34:56] Your.

Speaker 2 [00:34:56] Dress, your hair, your makeup, sometimes they'll pay for it, but a lot of times.

Speaker 1 [00:35:00] They won't.

Speaker 2 [00:35:02] And so just like if you ever get asked to be a bridesmaid, it's okay to be like, What's the budget for Everything? So I can plan accordingly. Because I feel like if you work for your money, like you're very like, cautious of like spending it in a frivolous way. And every single person that I've talked to now that's my age.

Speaker 1 [00:35:23] Is like, we're like, right. And we just like, no.

Speaker 2 [00:35:26] Not worth it.

Speaker 1 [00:35:28] Well, my friends, they'll try to do like bottle service for their birthday. And they're like, Oh yeah, the party bus is like 60 bucks plus \$100 per bottle service. I'm like, You guys are crazy. Like, for your birthday, I'm not. I'll go to your dinner and. Yeah, so pay all that money. Well, those.

Speaker 2 [00:35:46] Same friends have very high expectations for how their wedding days will be. So just let that be a alluding factor to what you might be predisposed to going down the road.

Speaker 1 [00:36:00] Definitely good perspective. I didn't even think about that because I don't even want a wedding like that. Like I if I get married, it's going to be something like super small. Yeah, like some of the.

Speaker 2 [00:36:11] Best weddings I've been to. We're like 30 people and it was so special. So I do think if we do get married, like, I'll have a celebration for my friends, but I would elope or do something like.

Speaker 1 [00:36:22] I don't know, like something.

Speaker 2 [00:36:24] Different but doesn't.

Speaker 1 [00:36:25] Waste.

Speaker 2 [00:36:27] Time and resources and energy and like, I'm also old now, so it's not that fun and exciting.

Speaker 1 [00:36:33] I never even thought it was fun and exciting. I'll put it in a honeymoon. Like I rather on vacation then. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:36:40] Oh, 100%. You can pay for a really cool vacation by doing that instead.

Speaker 1 [00:36:47] Okay. Oh, shit. I got sidetracked. Okay. Would you say the relationship is good for you? And why would you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:36:56] Yes, I would say it's good for me. I would say that opposites do attract. [Partner] and I are complete opposites, even being born basically [6-10] months apart. I'm [Month A]. He's [Month B]. We're literally opposite signs to like, I'm an [Sign A], he's a [Sign B], which are complete opposites. But he's taught me so many valuable lessons. And then we both push each other to grow in different ways. And where yeah, it's just complementary. It really is one of the most complimentary relationships that I've been in, even thinking of like my friendships or anything else like that. It's just I think it's a really good relationship as far as like growth and all of the other factors.

Speaker 1 [00:37:47] Have you noticed like previous relationships that didn't work out that they're too similar to you? You guys are very similar. Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:37:56] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:37:57] Yeah, yeah, yeah. Some personalities just can be like with the same type of personality. It doesn't go well and.

Speaker 2 [00:38:07] No, it does not go well.

Speaker 1 [00:38:11] So would you say that the relationship changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:38:17] Has. How has it changed me too?

Speaker 1 [00:38:21] Um.

Speaker 2 [00:38:23] Yeah, I think it's taught me to be a little bit more patient. And it's also taught me like to slow down too. I don't think if I wasn't in a relationship with [Partner] that I would have some of the perspectives that I do now.

Speaker 1 [00:38:41] Like, what would the perspective simply say?

Speaker 2 [00:38:44] I like his kindness and patience and like seeing the good in every single thing, Like his perspectives teach me that, you know, there is a different perspective than mine that you know, is just as good. And often, you know, there's a look like he's like a kind of like a positive, bright light. So I think that's kind of like how it's changed me as he's definitely led me to see. I'm just like the better side of things.

Speaker 1 [00:39:19] Were you more pessimistic before he met him?

Speaker 2 [00:39:22] Oh, yeah. After my last relationship, I hated everyone. I didn't trust anyone at all. I just thought all men were pieces of shit and that. You know what I mean? Like, they're like. I took it very slow, like getting into the relationship with [Partner] just because of, like, my jaded disposition and outlook on relationships.

Speaker 1 [00:39:43] Yeah. Yeah. You said to, like, [1-5] years of getting, like, knowing each other before we started dating. Mm hmm. Yeah, I'd say that's a pretty long time. Yeah. Do you think he was paid the. Oh, that speaks volumes soon. That's a green flag. Your partner, Did they change during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:40:06] Yeah, they've grown up so much. I think just from like. Their maturity level to their career level and to their understanding of like what it like. Takes to be in a relationship like they've had like a full glow up as far as just where we started and now where.

Speaker 1 [00:40:29] We're at currently. Okay. Yeah. Do you think, like, matured, matured, matured from you or from just my age?

Speaker 2 [00:40:41] Oh, men do not grow up just because of age. I will tell you that much. I definitely think I can do that. I don't want to sound cocky or anything, but I definitely think that I helped push that along a bit.

Speaker 1 [00:40:54] I'd say most people are most women feel that way. Yes. Give them that. Gave them the push to be. Exactly. So do you feel safe in your relationship and why would you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:41:10] Yes, because I can be literally just who I am to my core. I don't have to put up a mask. I don't have to. You cover anything. So I feel very safe in the relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:41:25] What about physically.

Speaker 2 [00:41:27] 100% physically as well?

Speaker 1 [00:41:30] Okay. And what are some examples of feeling safe in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:41:37] Okay, So I can tell him anything without judgment. You know, he's seen me just at my worst. Mental health going through big life changes, all of that stress of life and just like the highs and lows. You know, he's just truly seen all of that and kind of, you know, how I've gone through all of those things and has been there by my side through each and everything. And I think.

Speaker 1 [00:42:13] Like.

Speaker 2 [00:42:14] Because of just who I am by nature, like, I'm always asking like kind of, like, inquisitive, like more like deep questions and like opening myself up as well. And like, I can literally tell him anything and he will not judge me. And so I think that's really just like how I felt safe with him.

Speaker 1 [00:42:31] Yeah, that is definitely super nice to have. I'm going to share my screen. It's. Okay, Casey.

Speaker 2 [00:42:52] Let's see. Yes, I can. Now, let me zoom in on my screen to. Oh, yes. Perfect.

Speaker 1 [00:43:03] Perfect. So on a scale of one from not true at all to nine. Completely true. How do you feel about the statement of my partner? I usually really listen to me.

Speaker 2 [00:43:15] I would say eight. I think you're going to see I probably will never hit nine or one on this just because I don't think anything will ever be like complete. But I will say eight very close.

Speaker 1 [00:43:29] And then my partner usually is responsive to my needs. What would you put that as from the same scale that you. And from completely dissatisfied to completely satisfied. How satisfied are you with your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:43:47] Very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:43:50] And oops. Okay here. So how would you rate your relationship on a scale of zero to not at all satisfied to ten? Completely satisfied. Nine nine. That is it for the strain. And then I have some follow up. Questions at see. So when I asked. Sorry. It's asking me to sign into this. Okay. I'm just making sure. So, recording. Okay, So when I, as my partner, usually really listens to me, and you scored an eight. Can you give me a concrete example when he has listened to you?

Speaker 2 [00:44:55] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:44:56] So let me think of, like, a guy.

Speaker 2 [00:45:00] Well, he always if I sit down and say I need to talk like his. Very, very available and will open up. But I'm trying to think of like a concrete example.

Speaker 1 [00:45:15] Hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:45:19] I would say. Okay. This is a good example. I wanted to get like, received like more kudos for efforts that I had been making in certain regards to like an aspect of my life. And so. I told him what I needed, and then he repeated it and made sure he understood and then said that he would start to do it. And then he did start to do it.

Speaker 1 [00:45:49] Okay. And when would you say that he hasn't listened to you? If you could think of an example. Trying to think. Hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:46:07] I can't think of anything where again, it's not like. Kind of more like white noise conversation.

Speaker 1 [00:46:17] That's the first.

Speaker 2 [00:46:19] Thing that I can think of.

Speaker 1 [00:46:20] Is.

Speaker 2 [00:46:20] Driving.

Speaker 1 [00:46:21] It.

Speaker 2 [00:46:23] Um, yeah. I can't think of a time where I felt like he hasn't been listening to me.

Speaker 1 [00:46:29] It's actually really nice. It's hard. I feel for relationships nowadays with all I feedback.

Speaker 2 [00:46:36] It just might not like get around the driving and stuff. That is not like going to get taken wholeheartedly.

Speaker 1 [00:46:44] Yeah, just something silly like that. And when I ask, my partner is usually responsive to my needs. Can you give me an example when he has been responsive to your needs?

Speaker 2 [00:46:57] Yes. So. Previously mentioned. I have had like some mental health spouts where I have fallen into, I would say like hyper. Like I'm very anxious and kind of start to feel depressed as well. And I was basically like asking like, can you make sure like, I like, can you like, invite me to the gym and like, make sure like, you know, I don't fall out of my routine if you start to see me, like, Spiral. And so he's been really consistent with that and making sure, like, you know, a part of our like if we're going to spend time together, that we go to the gym and stuff and making sure that.

Speaker 1 [00:47:39] Like he's including.

Speaker 2 [00:47:41] Me in like some of the healthier activities because of not we have very separate routines. I like to do certain types of workouts. He likes to do other types of workouts, and we'll do them separately. But sometimes I just need a little bit more like motivation. If I'm in one of those more like depressed had spaces where I just don't have energy to do it. And so that's something he really listen to me on and has been really trying to make sure that if he ever sees, like any of those signs that he's very inclusive to like trying to make sure that he's a good partner during those times.

Speaker 1 [00:48:17] Wow, That's actually awesome. He definitely probably has a good parents.

Speaker 2 [00:48:22] He does. His mom is like the best person on this planet. He is very, very lucky.

Speaker 1 [00:48:28] Yeah, that tells you right there. This is family. It's good. Usually they end up being do. All right, so I help, if you don't mind if I ask, but feel free to say this is too sensitive for you. You don't have to answer any questions. You don't want to, But we'd like to. We'd like to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple these days. How often do you have sex?

Speaker 2 [00:48:57] Yeah. So I would say it's definitely relevant. Like, we've gone through some dry spells, especially when I am like, in those, like, really bad.

Speaker 1 [00:49:07] Head.

Speaker 2 [00:49:07] Spaces. Like, I'm just not. I'm not into it. Like, I don't feel good in my body. I don't feel good mentally. So I think when everything is like, healthy, it's like kind of more sporadic, like, you know, a couple, like it could be anywhere from like, you know, a few times a week to a couple times a month. And then during the like the mental health periods, like we can go without them, Like I could go easily without a like a full month without being touched and feel perfectly fine. Whereas he has expressed like he definitely, like craves and wants more of that. But he's very respectful that if I'm in a mental health bout, he's not pressuring or anything. Like he's very respectful that like, you know, it's kind of out of my control, like when I'm depressed and going through it and like working on myself, like physical touch is not my priority right now.

Speaker 1 [00:50:03] Right now that's like the last thing on. And how satisfied are you with their sex life?

Speaker 2 [00:50:11] I'm actually very satisfied. It's grown a lot as well. And that comes from communication, right? So I think like unfortunately, like, you know, men don't have a lot of positive examples of what, like healthy sex.

Speaker 1 [00:50:27] Should look.

Speaker 2 [00:50:28] Like a very, you know, like early age. And so like being able to kind of like be with someone this long, like we've come a like a far away with our our sex and like physical intimacy and are very comfortable like talking about our needs and like making sure like, you know what I mean? Like, I am I can I'm one who, like, I'm not going to be a woman who just, like, is satisfied with not having an orgasm during sex. Like, it's just I know so many people who don't have an orgasm during sex. And I just think that's so, like, unacceptable. Like what? What are you doing then? So I think it's definitely come a far away.

Speaker 1 [00:51:10] Yeah, definitely. So it becomes an issue after being with somebody for a while and then something. Get out the funk. Mm hmm. And General, I asked you this question already, so why would you say that you're very satisfied in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:51:34] I think just like all of the. All of, like, the little inner workings. Um, you know, like I'm satisfied because of, like, the person who I'm with. Like, I respect him, just

like his characteristics in general. But then as well as as far as, like, just all of, like, the foundational things as well make me very happy. Like, communication.

Speaker 1 [00:52:01] Like the like.

Speaker 2 [00:52:04] I don't know, words of affirmation that I receive and the support that I receive. And I just overall think like he's a very well-rounded person. And so.

Speaker 1 [00:52:18] I'm.

Speaker 2 [00:52:19] Trying to think like, yeah, just like all of it.

Speaker 1 [00:52:24] Okay. And I think. So did your relationship fulfill your expectations? Yes. Okay. I think that is for the questions. And I'll just like to summarize a little bit of what we have talked about in the past hour. See guys together for [11-15] years. There's no kids at the moment and plan. But maybe one day you'll freeze the eggs. And it seems like you guys have a really good, healthy balance of each other. You get everything you want out of the relationship. And he does, too. And obviously there's going to be some issues with it in a relationship, but it doesn't seem like anything too serious between you guys and seem very happy with each other and have. Very high status vacation. So who are you guys rooting for.

Speaker 2 [00:53:27] Right now until he drives crazy and pisses me off?

Speaker 1 [00:53:31] Just kidding. Well, I want to thank you again so much for taking your time today. And I wanted to talk a little bit of how we handle the data. Yeah. So we want to be as transparent as possible and we want to know which data sharing options you're most comfortable with. And that's it will be in the consent form too, where you'll check it all. But so the first option is. Transcript. Portions can be shared and none which can be identified use. So the de-identified transcripts can also be bi can be read by other researchers. So this one it conceals your identity more where like the entire transcript won't be there, but just like notes and the transcript will be there. And then option two is more of a bolder option where the whole transcript can be shared and removed of any sensitive or orally identifying information like names or anybody else you have mentioned. And so this will be anonymous. And then this option is has very minimal chance that somebody knows. You can piece together the details in the transcript and narrowed and narrowed down among who their colleagues believe who it is, although no sensitive information will be shared. So this one, the full transcript can be shared, but none of your name or anything that can directly identify you will be used. So anybody that knows you and your partner's relationship really well may be able to piece it together in the public. In the public like research. Once it published, it's up to you which option you want.

Speaker 2 [00:55:23] Okay. And I just read over and select it and the consent order, I tell you now.

Speaker 1 [00:55:28] You can tell me now and then in the consent, you can market down and then you'll sign your name.

Speaker 2 [00:55:34] Okay. Um, I'm not sure. I might just read over it one more time. Or do I have to tell you now.

Speaker 1 [00:55:40] At the time? Yeah. Like.

Speaker 2 [00:55:42] Yeah, I'm. I just read over it and just. It sounds like they're both pretty anonymous. I don't mind either or, but I just want to make sure I'll read, read over and select it.

Speaker 1 [00:55:52] Yeah, 100%. Take your time with it to. So I want to thank you again for participating in the study. And I also wanted you to know that this is also being done in the Philippines, Brazil, Netherlands, France and in the US. And yeah, that's pretty much it. Thank you again for taking your time.

Speaker 2 [00:56:18] Jan So far I have.

Speaker 1 [00:56:21] Well, I've done like pretty much all the women on all the couples, and that's like six.

Speaker 2 [00:56:29] Are you like also tracking the data of like how easy it is to get a hold of the women?

Speaker 1 [00:56:33] And like, the men.

Speaker 2 [00:56:34] Are like, so, like, bad at communicating. And I feel like.

Speaker 1 [00:56:39] It's so funny because, like, the answers will be a lot longer, like for the woman, like the interviews will run a lot longer with the women, and then the men will be a little shorter because they don't answer it as in much detail. But a lot of the reasons why people will participate is because of the man like doesn't want to.

Speaker 2 [00:56:59] Funny opposite here is that we got volunteered by [Partner] side of like the thing I don't know the connection somewhat I think his mom knows your mom.

Speaker 1 [00:57:09] Yeah. Yeah, they're friends.

Speaker 2 [00:57:13] But yeah, that is. That is so funny. I was just thinking about that because I was like, he had he did go to jury duty, by the way, but he didn't follow up after. And so and then I kind of forgot. I was like I forgot that he didn't follow up. So I'll give him a little push and see, make sure that his schedule is available. But I'm pretty sure if you have time Friday he can probably do it. Then he's just travels are like in office. Whereas I'm from home right now, so it's easier to do like this in between my meetings. But yeah, I'll. I'll make sure he gets back to you. Are you in a relationship?

Speaker 1 [00:57:54] Yeah, I am, actually.

Speaker 2 [00:57:56] Has this, like, opened your perspective a little bit more about, like, what you want and in your relationship or like, the next steps or anything.

Speaker 1 [00:58:04] I would say it definitely. So I'm going to just stop.